

Chapter 10: Shoes

The interior decoration of this store was exceptionally minimalist. Apart from the essential shoe racks and sofas and mirrors for customers to try on shoes, there was nothing else.

Outside the store was a crowded and noisy street, but inside it was unusually quiet, with only one store clerk present.

As soon as the two stepped into the store, they smelled a comfortable, light incense fragrance, which undoubtedly made them both feel much more comfortable.

Mo Yixu declined the clerk's shopping assistance and silently followed behind Yan Lin.

Yan Lin's gaze quietly swept over every pair of shoes in the store, until she reached the end of the women's shoe section and stopped in front of a shoe rack.

It was a pair of mid-heel shoes with modest heels. The shoes were made of pure black suede fabric with full coverage, and the slightly pointed toe was decorated with scattered crystal-clear diamonds.

This pair of shoes was beautiful, but it was just that ordinary, common kind of beautiful - nothing particularly attractive, and nothing particularly disagreeable.

Ordinary.

But inexplicably, Yan Lin felt that this pair of shoes would be very suitable for Feng Yue. She could even imagine how these shoes would look on Feng Yue's feet.

"Wrap them up." Yan Lin pointed at the shoes and turned to the clerk standing nearby.

Seeing her choose this pair, the clerk's eyes also brightened, and she walked over while saying, "Miss, you have excellent taste. This pair is the most special in our store. Many customers think these shoes are too ordinary, but there are always some customers who notice them at first glance when they come to the store. The designer, Mr. Princer, described them as 'what fits is what's best.'"

Mo Yixu didn't understand anything about designers, but thinking carefully, if these shoes would really be worn by Mrs. Yan, they would indeed look very good - though that wouldn't be the shoes' credit, but Mrs. Yan's face's credit.

However, Yan Lin nodded slightly in agreement with the clerk's words. She believed these shoes were the most suitable design for Feng Yue, just as Feng Yue was the most suitable wife for her.

"May I ask what size the customer needs?"

Yan Lin froze, and even her gaze that had been wandering over other shoes stopped. She suddenly realized that her understanding of Feng Yue didn't seem to extend to her shoe size.

Mo Yixu's years of reading people's expressions weren't practiced in vain. After seeing Yan Lin's frozen expression, he immediately took out his phone to look through the information about Mrs. Yan that he had saved.

"Please get size 5.5." Mo Yixu smiled slightly at the clerk.

The clerk nodded and went to get the shoes. Mo Yixu saw her leave and then handed the information he had found on his phone to Yan Lin, "CEO Yan."

Yan Lin's neatly trimmed nails dug deeply into her palm. Although the nails weren't sharp, they still caused a dull pain in her palm.

She reached out to refuse Mo Yixu's phone and asked flatly, "Do you remember your girlfriend's shoe size?"

"Uh, yes..." Mo Yixu nodded somewhat awkwardly.

Yan Lin said nothing more, just lowered her eyes and nodded slightly.

Yan Lin didn't choose to have the shoes delivered to the hotel, but personally carried the shoe box packaged by the clerk, walking out of the store under the clerk's polite farewell smile.

After returning to the hotel, Yan Lin placed the shoe box on the table in her room, then stared at the shoe box silently for two minutes before looking away and sitting back at her desk.

She prepared to open her email to carefully look at some information about Feng Yue that she had asked Mo Yixu to send.

But before she could click on her email, the phone beside her rang.

Yan Lin looked at the caller ID on her phone, and the faint light in her ink-black eyes slowly dimmed.

Wei Yuran.

At nine in the morning, Feng Yue gradually awakened from her dreams. She felt the soft, skin-friendly bedding on her body, and like a little cat, she rubbed against it with some reluctance before sitting up vigorously on the bed.

Her life recently had been very regular: getting up at eight or nine in the morning, eating breakfast and taking a morning jog around the villa area, taking a shower and then tending to the roses in her greenhouse. After lunch, she would curl up in the air-conditioned room and quietly read books, taking naps when tired. In the evening, if Dai Shuangshuang invited her to dinner, she would go; if not, she would eat at home alone, and after dinner go to the media room to watch an old movie, then sleep.

In short, her life was very regular. Sometimes when she didn't want to cook for herself or felt a bit lonely, Aunt Liu¹ would come to the villa to keep her company, ensuring she wouldn't feel too uncomfortable.

Sharp-eyed Aunt Liu naturally noticed something wrong with Feng Yue - for instance, half an hour after every meal, Feng Yue would take out a pile of medicine bottles covered in English writing and take out many pills to swallow.

When Aunt Liu was curious and asked what Feng Yue was taking, Feng Yue would vaguely say she was taking vitamin pills, health supplements, and the like.

Aunt Liu didn't understand and didn't pursue the matter further.

After Feng Yue's morning jog, she went upstairs to shower, leaving her phone and everything downstairs. So when she came downstairs after showering, Aunt Liu handed her the phone and said, "Mrs. Yan, your phone rang for a while just now. The display showed 'Miss,' and it stopped ringing not long ago."

Feng Yue took the phone somewhat strangely and looked at the calendar. Logically, at this time, Yan Lin should still be worrying about overseas matters - how would she have time to call her?

Looking at the missed call, she really didn't want to call back, so she switched to WeChat and sent a question mark.

Feng Yue: ?

Yan Lin looked at this lonely question mark and somehow became nervous. She exhaled and directly called back.

The call was answered quickly.

"Hello, did something happen?" Feng Yue's voice was the same as usual, but Yan Lin seemed to hear a trace of impatience in it.

"I'll probably be home around eight tonight," Yan Lin said quietly.

Feng Yue: "Okay."

Then the two fell into silence. In the past, it was always Feng Yue who kept finding topics to chat about. Now that Feng Yue was silent, naturally they had nothing to talk about.

Feng Yue silently listened to Yan Lin's breathing coming through the phone, suddenly remembering that this seemed to be the first time they were on a call with absolutely nothing to say.

Feng Yue closed her eyes and quietly exhaled, asking, "Is there anything else?"

Yan Lin wanted to ask how her condition was, but thinking this matter was better discussed face-to-face at home, she said, "No."

"Alright, then have a safe trip."

"Mm."

"Mm, bye."

"Good... goodbye."

After Yan Lin finished speaking, Feng Yue hung up without hesitation.

Hearing the dial tone from the phone, Yan Lin stood there somewhat dazed. This was the first time she had heard someone else hang up on her.

Whether at the company or in past interactions with Feng Yue, it was always her, the one giving orders, who hung up first.

And Yan Lin indeed lived up to her reputation as someone who could control such a vast commercial empire - she keenly sensed Feng Yue's mood. The other party seemed a bit angry.

Yan Lin stood by the hotel's floor-to-ceiling window holding her phone, feeling helpless about Feng Yue for the first time.

After hanging up, Feng Yue changed clothes and went to the greenhouse, but before leaving, she informed Aunt Liu about Yan Lin's return.

"Aunt Liu, Yan Lin will be home at eight tonight."

"Alright, then I'll—"

"Please push back the dinner time a bit."

"Oh, oh, okay." Aunt Liu watched Feng Yue's departing figure, feeling surprised for the first time.

Usually when Miss went on business trips, Mrs. Yan would always let her leave early and cook personally herself. Mrs. Yan said that was their world for two.

But this time...

Around eight in the evening, Yan Lin's car arrived punctually in the villa's courtyard. Mo Yixu took the suitcase out of the trunk, and Yan Lin got out of the back seat, still carrying the shoe box that had traveled across the ocean to her home.

Hearing the commotion in the courtyard, Aunt Liu hurried out to take Yan Lin's suitcase.

The first person Yan Lin saw when returning home was Aunt Liu, which surprised her slightly. So when she didn't see Feng Yue after entering the house, she asked, "Where is Mrs. Yan?"

"Mrs. Yan is watching a movie in the media room. Please go call her down - dinner is ready." Aunt Liu placed Yan Lin's suitcase aside and then went back into the kitchen to work.

Yan Lin carried her suitcase upstairs to the bedroom, then turned to go to the media room to find Feng Yue, but felt something strange when leaving the bedroom.

It was as if this room hadn't been slept in for a long time.

Yan Lin suppressed her doubts and headed to the media room carrying the gift she had brought back from across the ocean. She reached out to push open the door - inside was very dark, with only the dim yellow wall lights on the opposite wall lit.

Yan Lin turned to look at the sofa and saw someone curled up there sleeping soundly, with slightly furrowed brows.

The movie's sound was very low, as if someone had deliberately turned it down for sleep aid.

Yan Lin glanced at the air conditioning temperature, put down what she was carrying, reached for a thin blanket nearby, and gently covered the person. She sat down quietly beside her and looked at the movie's progress bar, which didn't have much left, and began watching quietly.

But before Yan Lin could watch for long, the media room door was knocked, and in this tranquil environment, the knocking was particularly jarring.

Yan Lin silently turned to look at the sofa, and sure enough, the other person had already drowsily opened her eyes.

"Miss, Mrs. Yan, dinner is ready." Aunt Liu's voice came from outside the media room.

Seeing that Feng Yue was awake, Yan Lin responded, "Coming."

The person outside, having received a response, went downstairs. And the still drowsy Feng Yue was completely startled awake by Yan Lin's voice.

Feng Yue sat up from the sofa, and Yan Lin reached out to turn on the main light in the media room. Seeing Feng Yue's slightly tousled hair, Yan Lin almost instinctively reached out to help tidy it.

But when Yan Lin's hand reached over, Feng Yue slightly leaned to the side, avoiding Yan Lin's hand.

This happened within just a few seconds, and both froze in place for a moment.

Feng Yue blinked, carelessly ran her hand through her hair, and forced a smile, "Let's go down for dinner. I'm hungry."

But before she could stand up, Yan Lin, sitting beside her, stood up and handed the shoe box that had been placed nearby to Feng Yue.

"A gift."

Feng Yue's expression froze for a moment, her white teeth lightly biting her lower lip as she smiled softly, "There's even a gift. Thank you." She reached out to take the shoe box.

Feng Yue took the shoe box out of the bag and opened it. The pure black suede high heels appeared before her eyes.

To be honest, Feng Yue liked these shoes. Just as the clerk had said, there were always some customers who would fall for them at first sight in the store, and Feng Yue had also fallen for them at first sight.

Feng Yue smiled, her eyes curving into bright crescents, "Very beautiful, I like them very much."

Hearing this, Yan Lin seemed to breathe a sigh of relief.

"But—" Feng Yue's tone contained not a trace of blame or dissatisfaction, "the shoes from this store are half a size too small for me."

Yan Lin was instantly stunned.

"Let's go down for dinner." Feng Yue closed the shoe box, her voice very light. She actually didn't feel anything particular, just a kind of 'so that's how it is' deflated feeling.

Walking to the door, Feng Yue, carrying the shoe box, stopped and looked at Yan Lin, who was still sitting on the sofa, and said with a smile, "But thank you anyway for still remembering my shoe size."

After speaking, she turned and left, leaving only a bit of crystal clarity on the floor where she had been.

This was probably the last time she would shed tears for Yan Lin.

Footnotes:

¹ **Aunt Liu (刘妈):** A respectful way to address household staff in Chinese families, combining the surname with "Aunt" or "Mom" as an honorific title. Same character as mentioned in previous chapters.